

Linear algebra: Exercise Chapter 6

Morteza Rahimi

Autumn 2025

1. Compute determinant and inverse of the following matrices, if any.

$$A = \begin{bmatrix} 3 & -1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{bmatrix}, \quad B = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix}, \quad C = \begin{bmatrix} 6 & 0 & 2 \\ 1 & 2 & 0 \\ 4 & 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix}.$$

Answer.

Matrix A:

$$\det(A) = (3)(0) - (-1)(1) = 1,$$
$$A^{-1} = \frac{1}{\det(A)} \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ -1 & 3 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ -1 & 3 \end{bmatrix}.$$

Matrix B: Since two rows (first and third) of B are the same, so $\det(B) = 0$, and therefore, matrix B is singular and does not have an inverse.

Matrix C:

$$\det(C) = 6 \begin{vmatrix} 2 & 0 \\ 1 & 1 \end{vmatrix} - 0 \begin{vmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 4 & 1 \end{vmatrix} + 2 \begin{vmatrix} 1 & 2 \\ 4 & 1 \end{vmatrix} = 6 \cdot 2 + 2 \cdot (-7) = 12 - 14 = -2$$

Since $\det(C) \neq 0$, the matrix C is invertible.

To find the minors, M_{ij} , delete the row and column of each element in C , then compute the determinant of the submatrix. Next, compute cofactors $c_{ij} = (-1)^{i+j} M_{ij}$.

$$\begin{aligned} M_{11} &= \begin{vmatrix} 2 & 0 \\ 1 & 1 \end{vmatrix} = 2, & M_{12} &= \begin{vmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 4 & 1 \end{vmatrix} = 1, & M_{13} &= \begin{vmatrix} 1 & 2 \\ 4 & 1 \end{vmatrix} = -7, \\ M_{21} &= \begin{vmatrix} 0 & 2 \\ 1 & 1 \end{vmatrix} = -2, & M_{22} &= \begin{vmatrix} 6 & 2 \\ 4 & 1 \end{vmatrix} = -2, & M_{23} &= \begin{vmatrix} 6 & 0 \\ 4 & 1 \end{vmatrix} = 6, \\ M_{31} &= \begin{vmatrix} 0 & 2 \\ 2 & 0 \end{vmatrix} = -4, & M_{32} &= \begin{vmatrix} 6 & 2 \\ 1 & 0 \end{vmatrix} = -2, & M_{33} &= \begin{vmatrix} 6 & 0 \\ 1 & 2 \end{vmatrix} = 12. \end{aligned}$$

$$\text{Cofactor}(C) = \begin{bmatrix} 2 & -1 & -7 \\ 2 & -2 & -6 \\ -4 & 2 & 12 \end{bmatrix}, \quad \text{Adj}(C) = \text{Cofactor}(C)^T = \begin{bmatrix} 2 & 2 & -4 \\ -1 & -2 & 2 \\ -7 & -6 & 12 \end{bmatrix},$$

$$C^{-1} = \frac{1}{-2} \begin{bmatrix} 2 & 2 & -4 \\ -1 & -2 & 2 \\ -7 & -6 & 12 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} -1 & -1 & 2 \\ \frac{1}{2} & 1 & -1 \\ \frac{7}{2} & 3 & -6 \end{bmatrix}.$$

2. For an $n \times n$ matrix A with $\det(A) = -2$, find:

- (a) $\det(2A^T)$;
- (b) $\det(-A)$;
- (c) $\det(A^2)$;
- (d) $\det(A^{-1})$;
- (e) $\det(C)$.

Answer.

- (a) $\det(2A^T) = 2^n \det(A^T) = 2^n \det(A) = -2^{n+1}$.
 - (b) $\det(-A) = (-1)^n \det(A) = (-1)^{n+1} 2$.
 - (c) $\det(A^2) = \det(A.A) = \det(A) \det(A) = \det(A)^2 = 4$.
 - (d) $1 = \det(I_n) = \det(A.A^{-1}) = \det(A) \det(A^{-1}) \implies \det(A^{-1}) = \frac{1}{\det(A)} = -\frac{1}{2}$.
 - (e) $\det(C) = \det(C^T) = \det(\det(A)A^{-1}) = \det(A)^n \det(A^{-1}) = \det(A)^n \frac{1}{\det(A)} = \det(A)^{n-1} = (-2)^{n-1}$.
-

3. Determine the determinant of the following matrices by using cofactors and selecting an appropriate row/column.

$$A = \begin{bmatrix} 8 & -11 & 7 \\ -1 & 0 & 4 \\ 7 & -3 & 2 \end{bmatrix}, \quad B = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 1 & 2 \\ 3 & 0 & 3 & 0 \\ 4 & 8 & 1 & 1 \\ 7 & 0 & 1 & 0 \end{bmatrix}.$$

Answer.

Matrix A: Expand along the second row,

$$\det(A) = -(-1) \begin{vmatrix} -11 & 7 \\ -3 & 2 \end{vmatrix} + 0 - 4 \begin{vmatrix} 8 & -11 \\ 7 & -3 \end{vmatrix} = (-22 - (-21)) - 4(-24 - (-77)) = -1 - 4(53) = -213.$$

Matrix B: Expand along the second column,

$$\det(B) = -8 \begin{vmatrix} 1 & 1 & 2 \\ 3 & 3 & 0 \\ 7 & 1 & 0 \end{vmatrix} = -(8)(2) \begin{vmatrix} 3 & 3 \\ 7 & 1 \end{vmatrix} = -16(3 - 21) = 288.$$

4. Find the determinant of the following matrices by using determinant rules (don't compute it by using cofactors). You can use the results from the previous problem.

$$A = \begin{bmatrix} 4 & -1 & 7 \\ -9 & 2 & 2 \\ 4 & -1 & 7 \end{bmatrix}, \quad B = \begin{bmatrix} 4 & -1 & 0 \\ -9 & 2 & 0 \\ 14 & 7 & 0 \end{bmatrix}, \quad C = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 3 & 9 \\ -1 & 0 & 4 \\ 0 & 3 & 13 \end{bmatrix}, \quad D = \begin{bmatrix} 5 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & -6 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & -1 \end{bmatrix}, \quad E = \begin{bmatrix} 6 & 2 & 2 \\ 0 & 1 & -3 \\ 0 & 0 & 11 \end{bmatrix},$$
$$F = \begin{bmatrix} 4 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 9 & 0 \\ 7 & 0 & -2 \end{bmatrix}, \quad G = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 11 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 10 \\ 0 & 0 & -4 & 0 \end{bmatrix}, \quad H = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & -11 & 7 \\ -1 & 0 & 4 \\ 1 & -9 & 6 \end{bmatrix}.$$

Which of the above matrices are invertible?

Answer.

Matrix A: The first row and the third row of the matrix A are identical, so $\det(A) = 0$.

Matrix B: The third column of the matrix B is zeros vector, so $\det(B) = 0$.

Matrix C: $r_1 + r_2 = r_3$, so $\det(C) = 0$.

Matrix D: It is a diagonal matrix. $\det(D) = 5(-6)(-1) = 30$.

Matrix E: It is a triangular matrix. $\det(E) = 6 \times 1 \times 11 = 66$.

Matrix F: It is a triangular matrix. $\det(F) = 4 \times 9 \times (-2) = -72$.

Matrix G:

$$\det(G) = \begin{vmatrix} 0 & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 11 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 10 \\ 0 & 0 & -4 & 0 \end{vmatrix} \xrightarrow{r_1 \leftrightarrow r_2} - \begin{vmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 11 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 10 \\ 0 & 0 & -4 & 0 \end{vmatrix} \xrightarrow{r_3 \leftrightarrow r_4} \begin{vmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 11 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 10 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & -4 \end{vmatrix} = -440.$$

Matrix H:

$$\det(H) = \begin{vmatrix} 1 & -11 & 7 \\ -1 & 0 & 4 \\ 1 & -9 & 6 \end{vmatrix} \xrightarrow{r_2 \rightarrow r_2 + r_1} \begin{vmatrix} 1 & -11 & 7 \\ 0 & -11 & 11 \\ 1 & -9 & 6 \end{vmatrix} \xrightarrow{r_3 \rightarrow r_3 - r_1} \begin{vmatrix} 1 & -11 & 7 \\ 0 & -11 & 11 \\ 0 & 2 & -1 \end{vmatrix} \xrightarrow{r_3 \rightarrow r_3 + \frac{2}{11}r_2} \begin{vmatrix} 1 & -11 & 7 \\ 0 & -11 & 11 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{vmatrix} = -11.$$

5. Solve the following two systems of equations by using Cramer's rule.

$$a) \begin{cases} 12x + 3y = 15, \\ 2x - 3y = 13. \end{cases} \quad b) \begin{cases} x + y - z = 6, \\ 3x - 2y + z = -5, \\ x + 3y - 2z = 14. \end{cases}$$

Answer.

Part (a):

$$\begin{aligned} A &= \begin{bmatrix} 12 & 3 \\ 2 & -3 \end{bmatrix}, & \det(A) &= \begin{vmatrix} 12 & 3 \\ 2 & -3 \end{vmatrix} = -36 - 6 = -42, \\ A_1 &= \begin{bmatrix} 15 & 3 \\ 13 & -3 \end{bmatrix}, & \det(A_1) &= \begin{vmatrix} 15 & 3 \\ 13 & -3 \end{vmatrix} = -45 - 39 = -84, \\ A_2 &= \begin{bmatrix} 12 & 15 \\ 2 & 13 \end{bmatrix}, & \det(A_2) &= \begin{vmatrix} 12 & 15 \\ 2 & 13 \end{vmatrix} = 156 - 30 = 126. \\ x &= \frac{\det(A_1)}{\det(A)} = \frac{-84}{-42} = 2, & y &= \frac{\det(A_2)}{\det(A)} = \frac{126}{-42} = -3. \end{aligned}$$

Part (b):

$$\begin{aligned} A &= \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 & -1 \\ 3 & -2 & 1 \\ 1 & 3 & -2 \end{bmatrix}, & \det(A) &= 1 \begin{vmatrix} -2 & 1 \\ 3 & -2 \end{vmatrix} - 1 \begin{vmatrix} 3 & 1 \\ 1 & -2 \end{vmatrix} + (-1) \begin{vmatrix} 3 & -2 \\ 1 & 3 \end{vmatrix} = (4 - 3) - (-6 - 1) - (9 - (-2)) = -3, \\ A_1 &= \begin{bmatrix} 6 & 1 & -1 \\ -5 & -2 & 1 \\ 14 & 3 & -2 \end{bmatrix}, & \det(A_1) &= 6 \begin{vmatrix} -2 & 1 \\ 14 & -2 \end{vmatrix} - 1 \begin{vmatrix} -5 & 1 \\ 14 & -2 \end{vmatrix} + (-1) \begin{vmatrix} -5 & -2 \\ 14 & 3 \end{vmatrix} = 6(4 - 3) - (10 - 14) - (-15 - (-28)) = -3, \\ A_2 &= \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 6 & -1 \\ 3 & -5 & 1 \\ 1 & 14 & -2 \end{bmatrix}, & \det(A_2) &= 1 \begin{vmatrix} -5 & 1 \\ 14 & -2 \end{vmatrix} - 6 \begin{vmatrix} 3 & 1 \\ 1 & -2 \end{vmatrix} + (-1) \begin{vmatrix} 3 & -5 \\ 1 & 14 \end{vmatrix} = (10 - 14) - 6(-6 - 1) - (42 - (-5)) = -9, \\ A_3 &= \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 & 6 \\ 3 & -2 & -5 \\ 1 & 3 & 14 \end{bmatrix}, & \det(A_3) &= 1 \begin{vmatrix} -2 & -5 \\ 3 & 14 \end{vmatrix} - 1 \begin{vmatrix} 3 & -5 \\ 1 & 14 \end{vmatrix} + 6 \begin{vmatrix} 3 & -2 \\ 1 & 3 \end{vmatrix} = (-28 - (-15)) - (42 - (-5)) + 6(9 - (-2)) = 6, \\ x &= \frac{\det(A_1)}{\det(A)} = \frac{-3}{-3} = 1, & y &= \frac{\det(A_2)}{\det(A)} = \frac{-9}{-3} = 3, & z &= \frac{\det(A_3)}{\det(A)} = \frac{6}{-3} = -2. \end{aligned}$$

6. Let n be an odd number and A an $n \times n$ matrix such that $A^T = -A$. Show that A is not invertible.

Answer.

$$\det(A) = \det(A^T) = \det(-A) = (-1)^n \det(A) = -\det(A) \implies \det(A) = 0.$$

7. Suppose $\det(A) = 1$ and you know all the cofactors of A . How can you find A^{-1} ?

Answer.

Using the cofactors of A , we can form the cofactor matrix C . Then, since $\det(A) = 1$, we have

$$A^{-1} = \frac{C^T}{\det(A)} = C^T \iff A = (C^T)^{-1}.$$

8. Write a Python code that prompts the user to enter a matrix and then compute the determinant of that.

Answer.

```

1 import numpy as np
2
3 def recursive_determinant(A):
4     """
5     Compute the determinant of a square matrix A recursively.
6     """
7     n = A.shape[0]
8
9     # Base case for 1x1 matrix
10    if n == 1:
11        return A[0, 0]
12
13    # Base case for 2x2 matrix
14    if n == 2:
15        return A[0, 0]*A[1, 1] - A[0, 1]*A[1, 0]
16
17    # Recursive case for n > 2
18    det_value = 0
19    for col in range(n):
20        sub_matrix = np.delete(np.delete(A, 0, axis=0), col, axis=1)
21        cofactor = ((-1) ** (col)) * A[0, col]
22        det_value += cofactor * recursive_determinant(sub_matrix)
23    return det_value
24
25
26 # ----- MAIN PROGRAM -----
27
28 # Input from user
29 matrix_str = input("Enter the square matrix A (e.g. [[1,2,3],[4,5,6],[7,8,9]]): ")
30 A = np.array(eval(matrix_str), dtype=float)
31
32 print("A =")
33 print(A)
34
35 # Check if matrix is square
36 rows, cols = A.shape
37 if rows != cols:
38     raise ValueError("Matrix is not square. Cannot compute determinant.")
39
40 # Compute determinant
41 det_A = recursive_determinant(A)
42 print(f"det(A) = {det_A:.2f}")

```